



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 20

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Fall Protection: When It Applies to Interior Work

OVERVIEW:

OSHA requires fall protection for construction workers at heights of 6 feet or more. Many finish carpenters assume fall protection is only for roofers and ironworkers, but open stairways, floor openings, mezzanines, and elevated work platforms all present 6-foot-plus fall hazards inside a

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. The most commonly overlooked interior fall hazard is the open stairway. Until permanent guardrails are installed and load-tested, open stairways are one of the most dangerous locations on any interior construction job. Temporary guardrails must be maintained at all open stairways. They must not be removed for material movement and then forgotten. If you remove a guardrail for any reason,
2. Floor openings — for HVAC, plumbing, stairs, and electrical — must be covered and marked. A proper floor opening cover must be capable of supporting at least twice the weight of anyone who might step on it, must be marked as a hole cover so workers know not to remove it, and must be secured so it cannot be accidentally displaced. A piece of scrap plywood set loosely over a hole is not a
3. As finish carpenters, we often need to work in areas where other trades have created hazards — and those hazards are not always in obvious places. Before starting work in any area of the building, take two minutes to walk the space and identify any fall hazards: holes in the floor, open elevator shafts, uncovered floor penetrations, and unguarded edges. Note what protection is in place and
4. Personal fall arrest systems — harnesses, lanyards, and anchor points — may be required for specific elevated work. If your supervisor tells you a harness is required for a task, that is an OSHA requirement, not a suggestion. Make sure your harness is properly fitted — not just buckled — before climbing. A harness that is not properly adjusted will not arrest a fall correctly and can

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Walk me around this job site right now and point out every fall hazard you can identify.
Q2: What is the procedure for covering a floor opening that is created during our work?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Identify all floor openings, holes, and leading edges on your site
- Cover floor openings immediately and mark them clearly with signage
- Guardrails around open edges are required at 6 ft or more height
- Never remove guardrails without a formal fall protection plan in place
- Report any uncovered openings to your supervisor immediately

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 20

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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